

Information on the prevalence rates of non-communicable diseases (NCDs) by broad age groups is presented in Table 6.3.8. Accordingly, in the 0–14 age group, the highest prevalence rate was reported for asthma (0.9%). Among the 15–59 age group, relatively higher prevalence rates were observed for diabetes (6.0%), high blood pressure (5.8%), and high cholesterol (5.5%). Within the population aged 60 years and over, higher prevalence rates were reported for high blood pressure (36.4%), high cholesterol (27.0%), diabetes (26.8%), heart disease (8.4%), asthma (4.3%), and kidney disease (2.8%), respectively.

Table 6.3.8 : Prevalence Rates of Non-Communicable Diseases by Broad Age Groups, 2024

Age Group (Years)	Total Population	Diabetes	High Cholesterol	High Blood Pressure	Heart Disease	Kidney Disease	Thalassemia	Cancer	Stroke	Asthma	Epilepsy
Sri Lanka*	21,779,483	8.5	8.2	10.1	2.5	0.8	0.1	0.4	0.6	1.8	0.3
0 - 14	4,506,783	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.3	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.9	0.2
15 - 59	13,352,732	6.0	5.5	5.8	1.4	0.4	0.1	0.3	0.3	1.4	0.3
60 & Over	3,919,968	26.8	27.0	36.4	8.4	2.8	0.1	1.2	2.3	4.3	0.3

*Excluding the roofless population

Prevalence Rates of Non-Communicable Diseases by Marital Status

The distribution of non-communicable diseases according to the marital status of the population is presented in Table 6.3.9. When analyzing prevalence rates by marital status, the highest prevalence of NCDs is reported among the widowed population. Specifically, the rates for high blood pressure (40.4%), high cholesterol (29.5%), and diabetes (27%) are more than four times higher than the national average in Sri Lanka. Additionally, heart disease (7.5%) and asthma (4.8%) also show high prevalence rates within the widowed population. Furthermore, the prevalence rate for stroke among widowed individuals (2.1%) is significantly higher than in all other categories.

Table 6.3.9 : Prevalence Rates of Non-Communicable Diseases by Marital Status, 2024

Marital Status	Total Population	Diabetes	High Cholesterol	High Blood Pressure	Heart Disease	Kidney Disease	Thalassemia	Cancer	Stroke	Asthma	Epilepsy
Sri Lanka*	21,779,483	8.5	8.2	10.1	2.5	0.8	0.1	0.4	0.6	1.8	0.3
Never Married	9,099,161	0.8	0.7	0.9	0.4	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.9	0.4
Married	11,160,358	12.7	12.0	14.2	3.5	1.1	0.1	0.5	0.8	2.2	0.2
Widowed	1,234,122	27.0	29.5	40.4	7.5	2.2	0.1	1.2	2.1	4.8	0.3
Divorced	74,303	10.6	10.8	11.9	2.8	0.9	0.1	0.7	0.7	2.6	0.6
Legally Separated	44,887	10.1	10.8	11.6	2.8	0.9	0.1	0.8	0.7	2.8	0.6
Separated (Not legally)	166,652	10.2	10.7	12.4	3.3	1.2	0.1	0.8	0.8	3.6	0.7

*Excluding the roofless population

The reporting of non-communicable diseases (NCDs) is lowest among never married individuals. The prevalence rates for high blood pressure (0.9%), diabetes (0.8%), and high cholesterol (0.7%) are all below 1 percent. This may be due to the fact that the majority of individuals in this category belong to younger age groups.